UBUNTU 11.10

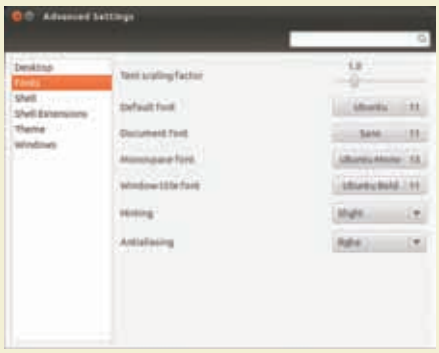
The much anticipated iteration of Ubuntu, Ubuntu 11.10 Oneiric Ocelot is finally here. And as is the norm with all October releases, this one is more polished and packs in a large number of improvements over its predecessor. Here are some tips to enhance your Ubuntu experience.

Tweak the appearance

Appearance settings lack the depth and range of operations which could be performed in the previous versions. To get back full control and the look and feel of the gnome shell, use the Gnome Tweak Tool. You can download it in two ways, either use the software centre or the command-line.

To get it using Software Center, fire up Software Center and search for Advanced Settings, click on Install and you're done. Installing it via Terminal is also easy, open up Terminal and use the following command

```
sudo apt-get install gnome-tweak-tool
```

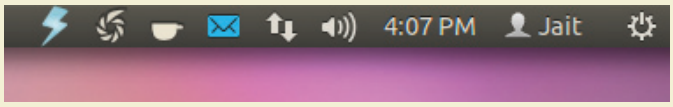


Make Gnome look the way you want it to

Once installed the applications is listed as Advanced Settings in the Dash, you can use it to manage themes, fonts, desktop and shell behaviour.

Re-enable the notification area

By default all the applications do not have the privileges to reside in the system tray. This is especially true for applications like Shutter or Jupiter. To enable this you must white-list these applications.



Systray in all its glory!

Use the following command in a terminal:

```
gsettings set com.canonical.Unity.Panel systray-whitelist "['all']"
```

Log out and log in again and Voila! You're done.

Configure Unity

You can tweak some parts of Unity's behaviour, such as use of the Super(Windows) Key, time-out after which the Dash is hidden and so on, using the Compiz Config Settings Manager. Download it using apt-get from the terminal, use the following command:

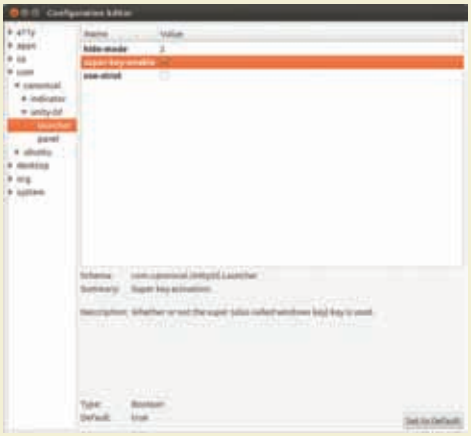
```
sudo apt-get install compizconfig-settings-manager
```

Open the just downloaded Compiz Config Settings Manager, click on Ubuntu Unity Plugin to get a list of all Unity settings.

In case your system is running Unity 2D, you'll need the dconf-tool to make changes similar to Compiz Config Manager. To get the dconf-tool, open up a terminal and enter the following command:

```
sudo apt-get install dconf-tool
```

After the apt-get completes downloading dconf-tool you can change the setting using the dconf-editor. Start the dconf-editor by entering dconf-editor at the prompt and hitting enter. You'll find Unity 2D's settings under `com > canonical > unity-2d`,. You have two options here: launcher and panel. After you have made the changes hit the Set to Default button to save your configuration settings.



Change Unity 2D behaviour using dconf-editor

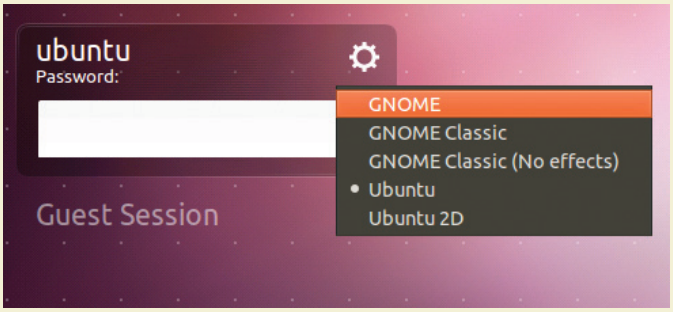
Install Gnome 3.0

Gnome is no longer shipped with Ubuntu, you'll need to download it separately. Fire up a terminal, enter the following command:

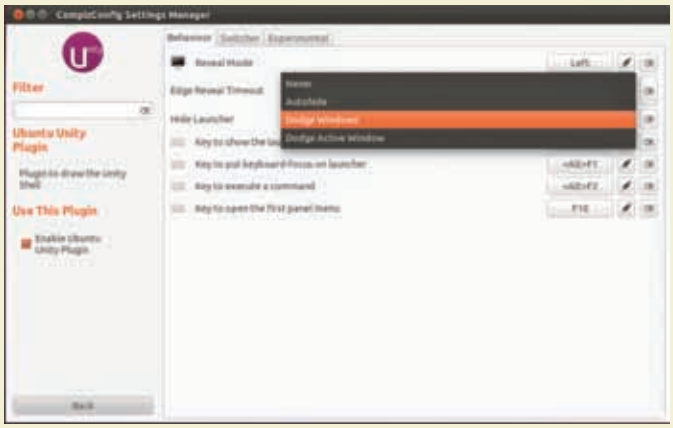
```
sudo apt-get install gnome-shell
```

This will download and install Gnome 3,. After it completes, log out of the current session. On logging out you'll reach LightDM.

Click on the small gear in the login box, which will let you select which session you want to log in to. Select Gnome, enter your password and log in, you'll now log into a Gnome 3 session. Have fun exploring!



Logging into a Gnome session



Using Compiz Config Settings Manager to tweak Unity

Gnome 3.0 desktop